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| United States Patent | 12408965           |
| Kind Code            | B2                 |
| Date of Patent       | September 09, 2025 |
| Inventor(s)          | Sayger; Daniel     |

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### Bone sliver removal system

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#### Abstract

A surgical tool and related methods are provided for removal of a bone sliver from a resected joint. The tool can include a housing including an upper end, a lower end, and a channel extending from the upper end to the lower end. A paddle member extends from the lower end of the housing. The paddle member includes a paddle shaft and a paddle head. The surgical tool further includes an insertion member that has a handle end, an extension that extends from the handle end, and a cutting tip. The extension is translatable within the channel such that the handle end and the cutting tip can move relative to the housing between a retracted position and an advanced position.

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| <b>Appl. No.:</b> | <b>18/058889</b>                                       |
| <b>Filed:</b>     | <b>November 28, 2022</b>                               |

#### Prior Publication Data

|                            |                         |
|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Document Identifier</b> | <b>Publication Date</b> |
| US 20230165616 A1          | Jun. 01, 2023           |

#### Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63264776 20211201

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#### Publication Classification

**Int. Cl.:** A61B17/88 (20060101); A61B17/15 (20060101); A61B17/56 (20060101)

**U.S. Cl.:**

**CPC**      **A61B17/8897** (20130101); **A61B17/152** (20130101); A61B2017/565 (20130101)

## **Field of Classification Search**

**CPC:**      A61B (17/8897); A61B (17/152)

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## **Background/Summary**

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This claims priority to U.S. Patent Application Ser. No. 63/264,776 filed Dec. 1, 2021, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by references as if set forth in its entirety herein.

### **BACKGROUND**

#### **Field**

(1) This disclosure generally relates to surgical systems for resecting joints and particularly to procedures for correcting a bunion in a patient's foot.

#### **Related Art**

(2) A bunion is a deformity of the foot characterized by misalignment between the first metatarsal and the proximal phalanx of a patient's great toe. Bunions can be painful and make walking difficult. Surgical methods for correcting bunions can include resection of the tarsometatarsal joint to provide clearance for repositioning and alignment of the metatarsal bone. The resection can create anatomical material that can be difficult to remove from the joint. What is therefore needed is a method and apparatus for removing anatomical material from a joint space.

### **SUMMARY**

(3) A first aspect of the disclosure is a method of correcting alignment between a metatarsal and a cuneiform bone by fusing a tarsometatarsal (TMT) joint between an end of the metatarsal and the cuneiform bone. A first wire is inserted into the metatarsal, inserting a second wire into the metatarsal. A first guide aperture of a cut guide is inserted over the first wire and a second guide aperture of the cut guide is inserted over the second wire to align a slot of the cut guide with the end of the metatarsal. The end of the metatarsal is resected through the slot to form a resected face and separated bone material along a cut line. A paddle member of a bone material removal tool is inserted into the TMT joint between the separated bone material and the cuneiform bone. An

insertion member of the bone material removal tool is advanced into the TMT joint between the resected face and the separated bone material with the separated bone material between the insertion member and the paddle member. Advancing the insertion member includes extending a tip of the insertion member past the paddle member and severing a plantar tarsometatarsal ligament of the TMT joint and pinching the separated bone material between the insertion member and the paddle member. The separated bone material is removed from the TMT joint using the bone material removal tool. A third wire and a fourth wire are inserted into the cuneiform bone A position of the metatarsal and cuneiform bones is moved into a corrected configuration and fixed in the corrected configuration.

(4) A second aspect of the disclosure is a method of correcting alignment between a first bone and a second bone by fusing a joint therebetween. A paddle member of a bone material removal tool is inserted into the joint between the separated bone material and the second bone. An insertion member of the bone material removal tool is advanced relative to the paddle member and into the joint between the resected face and the separated bone material. The separated bone material is removed from the joint with the separated bone material between the insertion member and the paddle member.

(5) According to another aspect, a first wire is inserted into the first bone. A second wire is inserted into the first bone. A first guide aperture of cut guide is inserted over the first wire and a second guide aperture of the cut guide is inserted over the second wire to align a slot of the cut guide with the end of the first bone. The end of the first bone is resected through the slot. According to another aspect, a third wire and a fourth wire are inserted into the second bone. A positioning of the first and second bones is moved into a corrected configuration. The first and second bones are fixed in the corrected configuration. According to another aspect, the insertion member includes a cutting tip and advancing the insertion member includes extending the cutting tip past the paddle member and severing at least one ligament of the joint. According to another aspect, the at least one ligament includes a plantar tarsometatarsal ligament and the joint is a TMT joint. According to another aspect, advancing the insertion member along the resected face and the separated bone material flexes the paddle member to create a compression force on the separated bone material between the insertion member and the paddle member. According to another aspect, the paddle member includes a plurality of retention barbs.

(6) A third aspect of the disclosure includes a surgical tool for removal of a resected bone material. The tool includes a housing with an upper end, a lower end, and a channel extending from the upper end to the lower end. A paddle member extends from the lower end of the housing, the paddle member including a shaft and a head. An insertion member includes a handle end, an extension and a tip portion. The extension slidably mounts within the channel such that the handle end and the tip portion can move relative to the housing along a first dimension between an advanced configuration and a retracted configuration.

(7) According to another aspect, the head of the paddle member includes a plurality of retention features, the retention features on a first side of the head facing the insertion member.

(8) According to another aspect, the plurality of retention features include angled horizontal slots. According to another aspect, the plurality of retention features include barbs.

(9) According to another aspect, the upper end of the housing includes a concave portion configured to receive a convex portion of the handle end of the insertion member in the advanced configuration. According to another aspect, the convex portion of the handle end of the insertion member includes a ring. According to another aspect, the extension of the insertion member is parallel with the shaft of the paddle member. According to another aspect, the insertion member includes a cutting tip and, in the advanced configuration, the cutting tip extends past the head of the paddle member in the first dimension. According to another aspect, in the advanced configuration, the insertion member is laterally offset from the paddle member by an offset distance. According to another aspect, the shaft of the paddle member is more flexible than the extension of the insertion

member and is configured to flex outwardly when the insertion member is extended from the retracted configuration to the advanced configuration with bone material having a thickness greater than the offset distance positioned between the paddle member and the insertion member and to provide a retention force against the bone material and the insertion member.

(10) The foregoing summary is illustrative only and is not intended to be limiting. Other aspects, features, and advantages of the systems, devices, and methods and/or other subject matter described in this application will become apparent in the teachings set forth below. The summary is provided to introduce a selection of some of the concepts of this disclosure. The summary is not intended to identify key or essential features of any subject matter described herein.

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## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Various examples are depicted in the accompanying drawings for illustrative purposes, and should in no way be interpreted as limiting the scope of the examples. Various features of different disclosed examples can be combined to form additional examples, which are part of this disclosure.

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a patient's foot in a deformed configuration;

(3) FIG. 2A is a front elevation view of a bone removal tool.

(4) FIG. 2B is a rear elevation view of the bone removal tool.

(5) FIG. 3A is a side elevation view of the bone removal tool shown in a retracted configuration whereby an insertion member of the bone removal tool is in a retracted position;

(6) FIG. 3B is a side elevation view of the bone removal tool in an advanced configuration whereby the insertion member is in an advanced position;

(7) FIG. 4A is an exploded perspective view of the bone removal tool shown with the insertion member in the advanced configuration;

(8) FIG. 4B is an exploded perspective view of the bone removal tool;

(9) FIG. 5A is a perspective view of a patient's foot including a bunion deformity, showing a cut guide positioned to resect an end portion of a first metatarsal at a tarsometatarsal (TMT) joint between the first metatarsal and the cuneiform bone of the patient's foot;

(10) FIG. 5B is a perspective view of the patient's foot of FIG. 5A, but showing a cutting instrument inserted through a cut slot of the cut guide so as to resect the first metatarsal at the tarsometatarsal (TMT) joint, thereby creating a metatarsal sliver;

(11) FIG. 6A is a perspective view of the patient's foot, showing the cut guide positioned to resect an end portion of the cuneiform bone at the tarsometatarsal (TMT) joint;

(12) FIG. 6B is a perspective view of the patient's foot of FIG. 6A, but showing a cutting instrument inserted through a cut slot of the cut guide so as to resect the cuneiform bone at the tarsometatarsal (TMT) joint, thereby creating a cuneiform sliver;

(13) FIG. 7A is a perspective view the patient's foot of FIG. 6A, but showing the cut guide and cutting instrument removed, and of a paddle member of the bone removal tool inserted into the TMT joint with the insertion member in the retracted position;

(14) FIG. 7B is an enlarged side elevation view of the patient's foot showing the TMT joint of FIG. 7A;

(15) FIG. 8A is a perspective view of the patient's foot of FIG. 7A, but showing the insertion member in the advanced position in the TMT joint so as to capture the metatarsal sliver;

(16) FIG. 8B is an enlarged side elevation view of the patient's foot showing the TMT joint of FIG. 8A;

(17) FIG. 9A is a perspective view of the patient's foot of FIG. 8A, but showing the removal tool coupled to the metatarsal sliver and removed from the TMT joint, thereby removing the metatarsal sliver from the TMT joint;

(18) FIG. 9B is an enlarged side elevation view of the patient's foot showing the TMT joint of FIG. 9A;

(19) FIG. 9C is an enlarged side elevation view of the patient's foot similar to FIG. 3A, but showing removal of a bone sliver defined by a resected end portion of the cuneiform;

(20) FIG. 10 is a perspective view of the patient's foot showing correction of the bunion using a correction guide inserted over a plurality of wires within the first metatarsal and the cuneiform bone; and

(21) FIG. 11 is a perspective view of the patient's foot showing fusing of the TMT joint with the addition of a bone plate.

#### DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(22) The various features and advantages of the systems, devices, and methods of the technology described herein will become more fully apparent from the following description of the examples illustrated in the figures. These examples are intended to illustrate the principles of this disclosure, and this disclosure should not be limited to merely the illustrated examples. The features of the illustrated examples can be modified, combined, removed, and/or substituted as will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art upon consideration of the principles disclosed herein.

(23) The present disclosure can be understood more readily by reference to the following detailed description taken in connection with the accompanying figures and examples, which form a part of this disclosure. It is to be understood that this disclosure is not limited to the specific devices, methods, applications, conditions, or parameters described and/or shown herein, and that the terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments by way of example only and is not intended to be limiting of the scope of the present disclosure.

(24) Referring to FIG. 1 shows, a skeletal view of a patient's foot **100** is shown having one or more bones such as a medial cuneiform bone **108**, a first metatarsal **104**, and a proximal phalanx **103** of the patient's great toe. The foot **100** defines a tarsometatarsal joint or TMT joint **106** between the metatarsal **104** and the medial cuneiform bone **108**. The foot **100** is shown in an initial or deformed configuration having a deformity such as a bunion **102**. The metatarsal **104** can be misaligned with the phalanx **103** when the foot **100** is in the deformed configuration. The metatarsal **104** can be oriented at an angle with respect to the phalanx **103**. A high degree of misalignment between the metatarsal **104** and the proximal phalanx **103** can lead to severe pain and rubbing and discomfort and other problems in the patient's foot **100**. Accordingly, it can be beneficial to correct the alignment between the metatarsal **104** and the proximal phalanx **103** of the great toe.

(25) A proximal end of the first metatarsal **104** can be connected with a distal end of medial cuneiform bone **108**, for instance by one or more ligaments. A proximal direction is defined from the metatarsal **104** toward the medial cuneiform bone **108**. Conversely, a distal direction is defined from the medial cuneiform bone **108** toward the metatarsal **104**. FIGS. 1-11 illustrate systems and methods of correcting alignment between the metatarsal **104** and the medial cuneiform bone **108**. In turn, proper alignment between the metatarsal **104** and the medial cuneiform bone **108** can correct alignment between the metatarsal **104** and the proximal phalanx **103**. Accordingly, the bunion **102** of the patient's foot **100** can be corrected. The present disclosure relates to systems and methods for correcting the deformed configuration. Moreover, the systems and methods described herein can be used more generally for correcting alignment between any two bones a patient's body.

(26) As will now be described with reference to FIGS. 2-4, embodiments described herein include methods and tools, such as a bone removal tool **120**, for removing bone material. In particular, embodiments described herein include tools and methods for removing bone material from a joint. In one example, embodiments described herein include tools and methods for removing bone material from the TMT joint **106** (see FIG. 1). The bone material can be defined by a sliver of bone formed after resection from a bone. In one example, the sliver of bone can be defined by the metatarsal bone. In another example, the sliver of bone can be defined by the cuneiform bone. While tools and methods described herein can have particular applicability to the TMT joint during

correction of a bunion **102**, it should be appreciated that the tools and methods described herein can apply to any suitable bone sliver created during any suitable surgical procedure as desired.

(27) As shown at FIGS. **2A-4** a deformity correction system can include a bone removal tool **120** that is configured to remove bone material from a joint, such as the TMT joint. The bone removal tool **120** can facilitate joint resection surgeries by removing bone fragments and/or cutting soft or hard tissues within the joint. The bone removal tool **120** can be particularly helpful for removing portions of bone, or bone slivers, that are cut from other portions of bone during a resection of joint. The bone removal tool **120** can also function to cut one or more remaining ligaments that may be attached to the sliver and prevent the sliver from being easily removed from within a joint after the bone is resected.

(28) The bone removal tool **120** can include a first member such as an insertion member **130**, and a complementary second member such as a paddle member **140** that are configured to cooperate with each other so as to couple the bone removal tool **120** to a bone sliver. The insertion member **130** can be configured as an osteotome or other suitable cutting instrument. The insertion member **130** can be sharpened so as to fit between a bone sliver that has been resected from a bone and a remaining portion of the bone that remains after the bone sliver has been resected. The insertion member **130** can further be configured to sever one or more soft tissue attachments of the TMT joint

(29) The insertion member **130** can include a handle **132**, and an extension **131** that extends from the handle **132** along a central axis **138** and terminates at a tip portion **133**. The extension **131** can be a linear member having a rectangular cross-sectional profile or any suitable alternative shape as desired. The handle **132** can be attached to a first end **136** of the extension **131** or can be monolithic with the first end of the extension **131** as desired. The handle **132** can define an outer perimeter **134a** that defines an opening **134b** in some examples. The handle portion **132** can thus facilitate a user to grasp and hold onto the insertion member **130**. In some examples, the perimeter **134a** of the handle **132** can define a circular or otherwise round ring. The tip portion **133** can terminate at a tip which can be sharpened so as to define a blade **135**. The blade **135** can be disposed in an opposition to the first end **136** of the extension **131**. The blade **135** can be defined be at least one bevel **137**, such as a single bevel **137**, that tapers to a cutting tip **145** as it extends in a direction defined from the first end **136** to the tip portion **133**. The tip **145** can be a sharp cutting tip in some examples. The bevel **137** can be positioned to face the paddle member **140** in some examples. Further, the tip portion **133** can define a single blade **135** or multiple blades as desired. Further, the blade **135** can be substantially straight, or can include serrations as desired, for instance. Thus, the blade **135** can be configured to cut remaining bone that may remain attached after the resection is performed, or soft tissue such as a ligament as desired.

(30) The bone removal tool **120** can further include a housing **150** that is configured to slidably receive the extension **131**. Further, the housing **150** can define a central member of the surgical tool **120** and act as a grip of the bone removal tool **120**. Thus, a user can grip the bone removal tool **120** by putting a thumb through the opening **134b**, and placing fingers into respective recesses **155** defined by the outer surface **156** of the housing **150**. The housing **150** can include an upper end **151** and a lower end **152** that opposite the upper end **151** along a downward direction. During operation, the downward direction can define an insertion direction into the joint **106** (see FIG. **1**). Conversely, the upper end **151** is opposite the lower end **152** along an upward direction, which can also be referred to as a removal direction opposite the insertion direction. Thus, the bone removal tool **120** can define a first direction **D1** that includes the upward direction and the downward direction. It is appreciated that the housing **150** defines the upper end **151** and the lower end **152** regardless of the orientation of the housing **150** during use. For instance, it is envisioned that during use the housing **150** can be oriented such that the upper end **151** is not, in fact, spatially positioned above the lower end **152**. Nevertheless, the upper end **151** and the lower end **152** are defined in such orientations. The upper end **151** can define a concave surface **157** that is sized and

configured to receive a portion of the handle **132**.

(31) The bone removal tool **120** can further define a channel **153** that extends between the upper end **151** and the lower end **152**. For instance, the channel **153** can extend from the upper end **151** to the lower end **152**. The channel **153** can extend from the upper end **151** to the lower end **152**. The channel **153** can be fully closed or partially open. The channel **153** can include an inner cross sectional shape that is sized to fit the extension **131** of the insertion member **130**. Thus, the extension **131** can be inserted into the channel **153** at the upper end **151** in the downward direction such that the blade **135** defines a leading end into the channel **153**. The insertion member **130**, and in particular the extension **131**, can be removed from the housing, for instance to facilitate cleaning or replacement of component parts of the bone removal tool **120**, including either or both of the housing **150** and the insertion member **130**. In particular, the extension can be removed from the channel **153** by sliding the extension in the upward direction until the extension **131** travels entirely out of the channel **153** at the upper end **151**. The channel **153** can capture the extension **131** to prevent removal of the extension **131** in a lateral direction perpendicular to the upward and downward directions.

(32) The insertion member **130**, and in particular the extension **131**, can be slidable within the channel **153** between a retracted position as shown in FIGS. 2A-2B and 3A and an advanced position as shown in FIGS. 3B-4A. The bone removal tool **120** can be said to be in an advanced configuration when the extension **131** is in the advanced position. Conversely, the bone removal tool **120** can be said to be in a retracted configuration when the extension **131** is in the retracted position. When the extension **131** is in the advanced position, the blade **135** at an advanced position that is spaced in the downward direction with respect to a retracted position of the blade **135** when the extension **131** is in the retracted position. When the insertion member **130** is in the advanced position, the portion of the handle **132** can interface with the concavity defined by the concave surface **157** defined by the upper end **151** of the housing **150**, such that the portion of the handle **132** is received in the concavity defined by the concave surface **157**. In some examples, the portion of the handle **132** can define a convex surface **139**. Thus, the surface **139** of the handle **132** can nest in the surface **157** of the housing **150**. It should be appreciated, of course, that the surfaces **139** and **157** can define any suitable size and shape as desired. In some examples, the portion of the handle **132** can interface with the concavity defined by the concave surface **157** such that the portion of the handle **132** abuts the concave surface **157** when the insertion member **130** is in the advanced position. In this regard, the surfaces **139** and **157** can define respective abutment surfaces of the handle **132** and the housing **150**. The interface between the handle **132** and the housing **150** can provide a feedback mechanism for the operator to indicate that the insertion member **130** has been fully extended to the advanced position.

(33) With continuing reference to FIGS. 2A-4B, and as described above, the bone removal tool **120** can further include the paddle member **140**. The paddle member **140** can include a paddle shaft **141** and a paddle head **142** that extends from the paddle shaft **141**. The paddle shaft **141** extends out from the housing **150** along a central paddle axis **148** in the downward direction to the paddle head **142**. In particular, the paddle shaft **141** can extend from a lower end **152** of the housing **150** in the downward direction. The central paddle axis **148** and the central axis **138** of the extension **131** can be oriented along the first direction D1. The paddle shaft **141** can be an elongate linear portion having a rectangular-shaped cross sectional profile or suitable alternative shape. In one example, the housing **150** can include a receptacle **154**. The receptacle **154** can be located on an opposite side with respect to the side that defines an opening to the slot **153**. The receptacle **154** can include an inner receiving space that receives an end portion of the paddle shaft **141** of the paddle member **140** that is opposite the paddle head **142**. The paddle shaft **141** is inserted into the receptacle **154** in the upward direction until the paddle shaft **141** abuts the housing **150**, at which point the paddle shaft **141** is fully seated in the receptacle **154**. In some examples, the paddle member **140** can be removable from the receptacle **154**. This can facilitate cleaning or replacement or component parts

of the bone removal tool **120**, including either or both of the housing **150** and the paddle member **140**. It should be appreciated, of course, that the paddle shaft **141** can be attached to the housing **150** in any suitable alternative manner. Alternatively, the housing **150** and the paddle shaft **141** can be monolithic with each other.

(34) The paddle head **142** can be disposed at a lower end of the paddle shaft **141**. The paddle head **142** can be attached to the paddle shaft **141** in any suitable manner. Alternatively, the paddle head **142** can be monolithic with the paddle shaft **141**. The paddle head **142** can define first and second major surfaces **144a** and **144b** that are opposite each other in a second direction **D2** that is perpendicular to the first direction **D1**. The first major surface **144a** can face the extension **131** when the extension **131** is in the advanced position. Thus, the extension **131** and the paddle head **142** can be aligned along the second direction **D2** when the extension **131** is in the advanced position. The extension **131**, and in particular the blade **135**, can be offset with respect to the paddle head **142** in the upward direction when the extension is in the retracted position. Further, the first major surface **144a** can be on the same side of the bone removal tool **120** as the opening to the channel **153**.

(35) The paddle head **142** can be an enlarged head having a width that is greater than a width of the shaft **141** in a third direction **D3** that is perpendicular to each of the first direction **D1** and the second direction **D2**. Each of the first and second major surfaces **144a** and **144b** can have respective outer perimeters that are generally curved, such as circular, or can define any suitable shape as desired. For instance, the head **142** can have substantially the same cross-sectional size and shape as the paddle shaft **141**, such that the head **142** is as an extension of the paddle shaft **141**. The head **142** can have a thickness from the first major surface **144a** to the second major surface **144b** along the second direction **D2**. The thickness can be flattened so as to be insertable into a joint between two bones, such as within the TMT joint **106** (see FIG. 1). In one example, either or both of the first and second major surfaces **144a** and **144b** can be substantially coplanar with the paddle shaft **141**.

(36) In some examples, the insertion member **130** can be oriented parallel with the paddle member **140**. Specifically, the extension **131** can be oriented parallel with the shaft **141** of the paddle member **140**. The extension **131** can be parallel with the shaft **141** in either or both of the retracted and advanced positions, and/or as the insertion member **130** moves between the retracted and advanced positions. The bone removal tool **120** can define an offset distance **R2** in the second direction **D2** from an inner face of the paddle shaft **141** to an inner face of the extension **131** that faces the inner face of the paddle shaft **141**. In particular, the inner faces of the paddle shaft **141** and the extension **131** can face each other along the second direction **D2**. In certain examples, the offset distance **R2** can be the same in both the retracted configuration and the advanced configuration. In certain implementations, the inner face of the paddle shaft **141** can be coplanar with the first major surface **144a** of the paddle head **142**, which can define an inner face of the head **142**. Thus, the offset distance **R2** can also be defined in the second direction **D2** from the first major surface **144a** of the paddle head **142** to the inner face of the extension **131**. The second major surface **144b** of the paddle head **142** can define an outer face of the head **142**. The second major surface **144b** can be shaped as desired. In one example, the second major surface **144b** is convex in a plane that includes the first direction **D1** and the second direction **D2**.

(37) The paddle head **142** can comprise a plurality of the retention features **143**. In particular, the retention features **143** can extend out from the first major surface **144a** that is configured to face the insertion member **130**, and in particular the extension **131**, when the extension **131** is in the advanced position. The retention features **143** can be configured as a plurality of projections **149** that extend out from the first major surface **144a**. The projections **149** can be angled as they extend out from the first major surface **144a**. For instance, the projections **149** can be angled in the upward direction as they extend out from the first major surface **144a**. Alternatively, the projections **149** can extend out from the first major surface **144a** in a direction substantially orthogonal to the



central paddle axis **148**.

(38) While the retention features **143** can be configured as projections such as barbs in one example, the retention features **143** can alternatively comprise one or more slots that extend into the first major surface **144a**, alternatively configured projections, a roughened or textured surface, or other features that can assist in retaining the paddle member **140**, and specifically the paddle head **142**, within a joint. For instance, it is recognized that the paddle head **142** can be advanced in the downward direction of insertion as it is inserted into a joint. Thus, the retention features **143** can be angled in a direction opposite the direction of insertion as they extend away from the first major surface **144a**. Thus, the retention features **143** can facilitate advancement of the head **142** into the joint. Once the paddle head **142** is disposed in the joint, it can be removed from the joint by moving the paddle head **142** in an upward removal direction. Because the retention features **143** can be angled in a removal direction as they extend away from the first major surface **144a**, the retention features **143** can resist removal of the paddle head **142** from the joint.

(39) During operation, and referring to FIG. 3A, the bone removal tool **120** can be in an initial retracted configuration whereby the tip portion **133** of the insertion member **130** is retracted within the housing **150** or disposed between the housing **150** and the paddle head **142** with respect to the first direction **D1**. Thus, the tip portion **133** can be said to be retracted relative to the paddle head **142**. Thus, the tip portion **133** can be retracted within the channel **153** or adjacent to the channel **153**. Accordingly, a reference line **R1** that extends along a direction perpendicular to the first direction, such as the second direction **D2**, along a downward-most end of the paddle head **142** does not pass through the extension **131** when the insertion member **130** is in the retracted position. In particular, the extension **131** is spaced from the reference line **R1** in the upward direction.

(40) As shown in FIG. 3B, The bone removal tool **120** can be moved from the retracted configuration to the advanced configuration. In particular, the extension **131** can be advanced in the downward direction in the channel **153** of the housing **150** relative to the housing **150** and the paddle **140** from the retracted position to the advanced position. The insertion member **130** can be advanced to the advanced position manually. For instance, the user's thumb can apply a downward advancement or insertion force to the handle **132** while fingers of the user engage the housing **150** to provide a counterforce that stabilizes the housing **150** with respect to the handle **132**. Therefore, the force applied to the handle **132** in the downward direction causes the insertion member **130** to move in the downward direction relative to the housing **150**, and thus relative to the paddle member **140**. An entirety of the insertion member **130** thus can be slid or translated relative to the housing **150** within the channel **153** in the downward direction. In particular, the insertion member **130** can be advanced in the downward direction until the abutment surface **139** of the handle **132** abuts or otherwise nests in the abutment surface **157** of the housing **150**, at which point the insertion member **130** can be in a fully advanced position. It should be appreciated that the advancement force can be applied to the insertion member **130** as a manual force or an automatic force in any suitable alternative manner as desired.

(41) As the insertion member **130** advances to the fully advanced position, the tip portion **133** similarly advances to a position beyond a lower most end of the paddle head **142**. Thus, at least a portion of the insertion member **130** can be offset with respect to the paddle head **142** in the downward direction when the insertion member **130** is in the fully advanced position. In particular, the blade **135** can be offset with respect to the paddle head **142** in the downward direction. Further, the extension **131** is aligned with the paddle head **142** along a direction that is perpendicular to the first direction **D1**, such as the second direction **D2**. Accordingly, the reference line **R1** that extends along a direction perpendicular to the first direction **D1**, such as the second direction **D2**, along a downward-most end of the paddle head **142** also passes through the extension **131** when the insertion member **130** is in the extended position. Desirably, the tip portion **133** can advance at least to a position aligned with the paddle head **142** along a direction perpendicular to the first direction, such as the second direction **D2**. As a result, the bone removal tool **120** can capture a

bone sliver between the paddle head **42** and the insertion member **130**, and in particular extension **131**, as will now be described.

(42) Referring now to FIG. 5A, the patient's foot **100** is shown including the deformed condition shown as a bunion **102** in need of surgical correction. The bunion **102** can be located between the proximal phalanx **103** and the first metatarsal **104**. The metatarsal **104** can form the TMT joint **106** with the cuneiform **108**. It should be appreciated that while techniques and apparatus are described herein with respect to the TMT joint, the techniques and apparatus described herein can alternatively be used in conjunction with any joint between any two bones in the body. In this regard, the first metatarsal **104** can be referred to as a first bone, and the cuneiform **108** can be referred to as a second bone that define a joint therebetween.

(43) With continuing reference to FIG. 5A, the deformity correction system can include at least one first or distal guide member or K-wire such as first and second guide members or K-wires **111** and **112**, that can be driven into the metatarsal bone **104**. The first and second K-wires **111** and **112** can be referred to as distal K-wires. The first K-wire **111** can be positioned distal of the second K-wire **112**. That is, the second K-wire **112** can be positioned between the first K-wire **111** and the joint **106**. The first K-wire **111** can thus be referred to as an outer distal K-wire, and the second K-wire **112** can be referred to as an inner distal K-wire. The K-wires **111** and **112** can be driven along a first K-wire insertion direction such as with the use of a guide, such as an alignment guide as described in U.S. Pat. No. 11,058,546, the entirety of which is hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes. The first and second K-wires **111** and **112** can be oriented parallel to each other, and spaced from each other along a first spacing direction.

(44) The deformity correction system can further include at least one second or proximal guide member or K-wire, such as third and fourth guide or K-wires **113** and **114** that can be driven into the cuneiform **108**. The third and fourth K-wires **113** and **114** can be referred to as proximal K-wires. The third K-wire **113** can be positioned proximal of the fourth K-wire **114**. That is, the fourth K-wire **114** can be positioned between the third K-wire **113** and the joint **106**. The third K-wire **113** can thus be referred to as an inner proximal K-wire, and the fourth K-wire **114** can be referred to as an outer proximal K-wire. The third and fourth k-wires **113** and **114** can be driven into the cuneiform **108** along a second K-wire insertion direction that is different from the first K-wire insertion direction. The third and fourth k-wires **113** and **114** can be oriented parallel to each other, and spaced from each other along a second spacing direction that is different than the first spacing direction. The third and fourth K-wires **113** and **114** can be inserted into the cuneiform **108** using a guide, such as an alignment guide as described in U.S. Pat. No. 11,058,546. After resection of the joint **106**, the distal K-wires can be positionally changed with respect to the proximal K-wires so as to correspondingly positionally change the underlying first metatarsal **104** with respect to the medial cuneiform bone **108**. In particular, the K-wires **111-114** can be received by respective apertures of a correction guide **300** (see FIG. 10) that drives the distal K-wires to positionally change from a first position shown in FIG. 5A to a corrected position shown in FIG. 10, thereby reducing or eliminating (i.e., correcting) the bunion **102**, as described further in U.S. Pat. No. 11,058,546.

(45) As shown in FIGS. 5A-6B, the joint **106** can be resected using a cut guide **200** and a cutting instrument **210**. Thus, the deformity correction system can include the cut guide **200** and the cutting instrument **210**. The cutting instrument **210** can be configured as an osteotome, bone saw, or other suitable cutting instrument as desired. The cut guide **200** can include a body **204** and a plurality of apertures, **205** such as first and second apertures **201** and **202** that extend through the body **204**. The first and second apertures **201** and **202** can be configured to selectively receive the first and second proximal K-wires **111** and **112**, respectively, and the first and second distal k-wires **113** and **114**, respectively. The cut guide **200** can further define a cut slot **203** that extends through the body **204** at a location spaced from the first and second apertures **201** and **202**. The cut slot **203** can be configured to receive and guide a cutting instrument **210** to resect the aligned cuneiform **108**

or metatarsal **104**, depending on which wires are received in the apertures **201-202**.

(46) In particular, referring now to FIGS. 5A-5B, the cut guide **200** can be driven over the first and second K-wires **111** and **112**, such that the first and second apertures **201** and **202** receive the first and second K-wires **111** and **112**, respectively, that are inserted into the metatarsal **104**. When the cut guide **200** receives the first and second K-wires **111** and **112**, respectively, the cut slot **203** is aligned with the metatarsal **104** at a location that will separate a first or metatarsal end portion **105a** of the metatarsal **104** from a remaining portion **105b** of the first bone or metatarsal **104** (see FIG. 7B). The metatarsal end portion **105a** that faces the joint **106**. It should be appreciated that the cut guide **200** can include the plurality of apertures **205** greater than two apertures. In one example, the second aperture **202** can be selected from one of the plurality of apertures **205**, such that the first and second apertures **201** and **202** are spaces as desired based on the patient's anatomy. The apertures **205** can be spaced in different locations that allow several options for aligning the cut slot **203** at a desired location of the metatarsal **104**. Thus, the cut guide **200** is configured such that the first and second apertures **201** and **202** locate the cut slot **203** as desired based on the patient's anatomy when the first and second apertures **201** and **202** receive the first and second K-wires **111** and **112**, respectively.

(47) In particular, the cut guide **20** can be positioned such that the cut slot **203** is aligned with the metatarsal **104** at a first or distal select location that separates the metatarsal end portion **105a** that is to be removed from a remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104**. Thus, the cut slot is configured to receive the cutting instrument **210** and guide the cutting instrument **210** to cut the metatarsal **104** at the first or distal select location. Thus, the cutting instrument **210** can be inserted through the cut slot **203** and guided by the cut slot **203** to cut along the distal select location which can define a first or distal resection cut **109** (see FIG. 7A) that separates the metatarsal end portion **105a** from the remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104**. The cutting instrument **210** can cut to a depth sufficient such that an entirety of the metatarsal end portion **105a** is separated from the remaining portion **105b**. The separated metatarsal end portion **105a** can define a first or distal bone sliver **107** (see FIG. 7B) of the joint **106**.

(48) Referring now to FIGS. 6A-6B, once the metatarsal **104** has been cut as described above, the cutting instrument **210** can be removed from the cut guide **200**, and the cut guide **200** can be removed from the first and second K-wires **111** and **112**. Next, the cut guide **200** can be inserted over the third and fourth K-wires **113** and **114** so as to align the cut slot **203** with the cuneiform **108** so as to separate a second or cuneiform end portion **115a** of the second bone or cuneiform **108** with a remaining portion **115b** of the cuneiform **108** (see FIG. 7B). The cuneiform end portion **115a** can face the joint **106** in the manner described above with respect to the metatarsal end portion **105a**.

(49) In particular, the cut guide **200** can be driven over the third and fourth K-wires **113** and **114**, such that the first and second apertures **201** and **202** receive the third and fourth K-wires **113** and **114**, respectively, that are inserted into the cuneiform **108**. When the cut guide **200** receives the third and fourth K-wires **113** and **114**, respectively, the cut slot **203** is aligned with the cuneiform **108** at a location that will separate the cuneiform end portion **115a** from the remaining portion **115b** of the cuneiform **108**. It should be appreciated that the cut guide **200** can include the plurality of apertures **205** greater than two apertures. In one example, the second aperture **202** can be selected from one of the plurality of apertures **205**, such that the first and second apertures **201** and **202** are spaces as desired based on the patient's anatomy. The apertures **205** can be spaced in different locations that allow several options for aligning the cut slot **203** at a desired location of the cuneiform **108**. Thus, the cut guide **200** is configured such that the first and second apertures **201** and **202** locate the cut slot **203** as desired based on the patient's anatomy when the first and second apertures **201** and **202** receive the third and fourth K-wires **113** and **114**, respectively.

(50) In particular, the cut guide **20** can be positioned such that the cut slot **203** is aligned with the cuneiform **108** at a second or proximal select location that separates the cuneiform end portion **115a** that is to be removed from the remaining portion **115b** of the cuneiform **108**. Thus, the cut slot

**203** is configured to receive the cutting instrument **210** and guide the cutting instrument **210** to cut the cuneiform **108** at the second or proximal select location. Thus, the cutting instrument **210** can be inserted through the cut slot **203** and guided by the cut slot **203** to cut along the proximal select location which can define a second or proximal resection cut **116** (see FIG. 7B) that separates the cuneiform end portion **115a** from the remaining portion **115b** of the cuneiform **108**. The cutting instrument **210** can cut to a depth sufficient such that an entirety of the cuneiform end portion **115a** is separated from the remaining portion **115b**. The separated cuneiform end portion **115a** can define a second or proximal bone sliver **117** (see FIG. 7B) of the joint **106**.

(51) While the cut guide **200** has been described as configured to selectively receive each of the distal K-wires **111-112** and the proximal K-wires **113-114** selectively, in another example a first cut guide can be configured to receive the distal K-wires **111-112** to align the cut slot with the metatarsal **104**, and a second cut guide can be configured to receive the proximal K-wires **113-114** to align the cut slot with the cuneiform **108**. While FIGS. 5A-6B show resection of the metatarsal **104** prior to resection of the cuneiform **108**, it should be appreciated that the cuneiform **108** can alternatively be resected prior to the metatarsal **104**. Further, while the same cutting instrument **210** can be used to resect the metatarsal **104** and the cuneiform **108** in one example, in another example different cutting instruments can be used to resect the metatarsal **104** and the cuneiform **108**.

(52) Referring now to FIGS. 7A-7B, as described above the first or distal resection cut **109** can separate the first or distal bone sliver **107** from the remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal bone **104**. The sliver **107** can be defined by the end portion of the metatarsal **104** as described above, and can remain in the joint **106**. It is desirable to remove the sliver **107** from the joint **106** to provide ample space in the resected joint **106** to allow for positional manipulation of the metatarsal **104** relative to the cuneiform in order to correct the deformity. The bone removal tool **120** is configured to grasp the sliver **107** and remove the sliver **107** from the joint **106**.

(53) It is recognized that after the resection, the bone sliver **107** can remain attached with the remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104** by soft tissue, such as one or more ligaments, that form the joint **106**. As one example, the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **110** can extend across the joint **106** and join the metatarsal bone **104** to the cuneiform bone **108**. The cutting operation that removes the metatarsal end portion **105a** from the remaining portion **105b** can also sever these one or more ligaments. However, in some instances it can be difficult to sever all of these ligaments because of the placement of the joint **106** and/or the location of the skin incision used to access the joint **106**. Thus, the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **100** can extend from the remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104** to the remaining portion **115b** of the cuneiform **108** after the cutting operations have been completed. The plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **110** is generally located on a plantar side of the joint **106**, while the skin incision is generally located on a dorsal side of the foot **100**, making access to the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **110** difficult. The bone removal tool **120** can further be configured to sever the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **110**.

(54) During operation, the paddle member **140** can be inserted into the joint **106** such that the first major surface **144a** faces the bone sliver to be removed. As illustrated in FIGS. 7A-7B, the bone sliver to be removed can be defined by the first or distal bone sliver **107**. In particular, the paddle head **142** can be inserted into the joint **106** to a depth whereby the paddle head **142** is disposed between the bone sliver **107** and the cuneiform **108** along the second direction D2. Thus, the bone sliver **107** is disposed between the paddle head **142** and the remaining portion of the bone, which can be defined by the remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104**. The paddle member **140** can be inserted into the joint **106** with the insertion member **130** in the retracted position. The retention features **143** on the head **142** can be oriented to facilitate insertion of the paddle head **142** into the tight joint space.

(55) Referring now to FIGS. 8A-8B, after insertion of the paddle member **140** into the resected joint **106**, the insertion member **130** can be driven into the resection cut which can be defined by the distal resection cut **109**. In particular, the insertion member **130** can be advanced in the

insertion direction into the distal resection cut **109**. For instance, the insertion member **130** can be advanced from the retracted position in the insertion direction into the distal resection cut **109**. In some examples, the insertion member **130** can be advanced to the advanced position. For instance, the insertion member **130** can be advanced to the fully advanced position. In other examples, the insertion member **130** can be advanced to a position that is advanced with respect to the retracted position, which can define the advanced position. The retention features **143** of the head **142** can aid in advancing of the insertion member **130** into the resection cut **109** without inadvertently removing the paddle member **140** from the resected joint **106**. In particular, the retention features **143** can grip the bone sliver **107**, stabilizes the housing **50** to provide a counterforce against the insertion force applied to the insertion member **130** that drives the insertion member into the resection cut **109**. It is also appreciated that the gripping the bone sliver **107** by the retention features can prevent the bone sliver **107** from inadvertently slipping out of the space between the insertion member **130** and the paddle head **142**.

(56) In one example, the extension **131** of the insertion member **130** can be extended to a depth whereby the blade **135** is aligned with the paddle head **142** along the second direction D2. The offset distance R2 (FIGS. 3A-3B) from the insertion member **130**, and in particular the extension **131**, to the paddle shaft **141** or the paddle head **142** (depending on the position of the insertion member **130**) in the second direction D2 can be less than the thickness of the bone sliver **107** in the second direction D2 in some examples. At least one or both of the shaft **141** of the paddle member **140** and the extension **131** of the insertion member **130** can be flexible relative to the other of the shaft **141** of the paddle member **140** and the extension of **131** of the insertion member **130**. Alternatively or additionally, the retention features **143** can be flexible relative to the first major surface **144a** of the paddle head **142**, and thus relative to the extension **131** of the insertion member **130**. Thus, it can be said that one of the insertion member **130** and the paddle member **140** can be flexible with respect to the other of the insertion member **130** and the paddle member **140**. In one example, the paddle member **140** (e.g., either or both of the paddle shaft **141** and the retention features **143**) is flexible with respect to the extension **131** such that the lateral position of the blade **135** along the second direction D2 remains substantially constant as it is inserted into the resection cut **109**. In other examples, the retention features **143** can be rigid.

(57) In one example, the distance from the tip **145** to the paddle shaft **141** or the paddle head **142** (depending on the position of the insertion member **130**) in the second direction D2 can be equal to or greater than the thickness of the bone sliver **107** in the second direction D2. Thus, as the extension **131** is inserted into the resection cut **109**, the tip **145** is inserted into the resection cut **109**, and the bone sliver **107** can ride along the bevel **137** as the extension **131** is further inserted into the resection cut **109**. As the bone sliver **107** rides along the bevel **137**, either or both of the insertion member **130** and the paddle member **140** can resiliently flex away from the other of the insertion member **130** and the paddle member **140**. In other examples, either or both of the extension **131** and the paddle shaft **141** can be manually deflected away from the other of the extension **131** and the paddle shaft **141** so as to provide clearance that allows the tip **145** to be inserted in the resection cut **109** and place the bone sliver **107** between the extension **131** and the paddle head **142**. Therefore, the bone sliver **107** can be captured in a retention space **146** between the insertion member **130**, and in particular the extension **131**, and the paddle member **140**, and in particular the paddle head **142**. The insertion member **130**, and in particular the extension **131**, and the paddle member **140**, and in particular the paddle head **142**, can cooperate to apply a normal retention force against the bone sliver **107** that retains the bone sliver **107** in the retention space **146**. When the paddle shaft **141** is flexible, the bone sliver **107** can cause the paddle shaft **141** to flex as the bone sliver **107** rides along the bevel **137**, which displaces the paddle head **142** outwardly along the second direction D2 away from the extension **131**.

(58) In some examples, the extension **131** can be advanced until the tip portion **133** can be aligned with the paddle head **142** along the second direction D2, such that the bone sliver **107** is captured

between the tip portion **133** and the paddle head **142**. The bone removal tool **120**, including the insertion member **130** and the paddle member **140** can then be removed from the patient's foot **100** in the removal direction so as to remove the sliver **107** from the resected joint **106** (see, e.g., FIGS. **9A-9B**). Alternatively, the extension **131** can be advanced until the tip portion **133** is offset with respect to the paddle head **142** in the insertion direction, such that the bone sliver **107** is captured between the extension **131** and the paddle head **142** prior to removing the bone removal tool **120** from the patient's foot.

(59) In some instances, it may be desirable to sever the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **110** with the bone removal tool **120**, for example when the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament was not severed during resection of the joint **106**. Advancement of the extension **131** such that the tip portion **133** travels past the paddle head **142** in the insertion direction can cause the tip **145** and blade **135** to sever the tarsometatarsal ligament **110** at a location adjacent the bone sliver **107**. It is also recognized that in some circumstances, the bone sliver **107** is not fully separated from the remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104**. In such instances, advancement of the extension **131** can cause the tip **145** and the blade **135** to fully separate the bone sliver **107** from the remaining portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104**. It is recognized that the bone sliver **107** remains captured between the paddle head **142** and the extension **131** after the tarsometatarsal ligament **110** has been severed. Severance of the one or more ligaments, such as the tarsometatarsal ligament **110**, can aid in the removal of the sliver **107** from the joint **106**.

(60) Referring now to FIGS. **9A-9B** in particular, once the bone sliver **107** is captured in the retention space **146**, the bone removal tool **102** can be removed from the resected joint **106**, thereby removing the bone sliver **107** from the resected joint **106**. Thus, when the bone sliver is defined by the metatarsal end portion **105a**, the remaining end portion **105b** of the metatarsal **104** can face or at partially define the resected joint **106**. In particular, the insertion member **130**, the paddle member **140**, and the housing **150** can all be moved in the removal direction from the patient's foot **100**. The insertion member **130** and the paddle member **140** carry the captured bone sliver **107** from the resected joint **106**. In situations where the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **110** was severed at a location adjacent the bone sliver **107**, removal of the bone sliver **107** can cause another location of the ligament **110** to be severed. In particular, manipulation of the bone sliver **107** can cause the ligament **110** to stretch and twist until the ligament is torn **110**, thereby freeing the bone sliver **107** from the patient's foot **100**. The bone sliver **107** is then removed along with a resected portion **110a** of the ligament **110** from the patient's foot in the manner described above. Alternatively, any suitable supplemental cutting instrument can sever the other location of the ligament **100** so as to free the bone sliver **107** from the patient's foot **100**.

(61) FIGS. **7A-9B** show removal of the distal bone sliver **107**. The steps associated with removal of the distal bone sliver **107** can be repeated for the proximal bone sliver **117**, which is opposite the distal bone sliver **107** along the second direction. Thus, as shown at FIG. **9C**, the proximal bone sliver **117** can be captured in the retention space **146** and removed from the patient's foot **100** in the manner described above with respect to the distal bone sliver **107**. The proximal bone sliver **117** can be removed using the same removal tool **120** or a second removal tool **120**. In particular, paddle head **142** is inserted into the joint **106** between the proximal bone sliver **117** and the first bone **104**, such that the first major surface **144a** of the paddle head **142** faces the bone sliver **117**. The extension **131** of the insertion member **130** can be inserted between the proximal bone sliver **117** and the remaining portion **115b** of the cuneiform **108**, thereby capturing the proximal bone sliver **117** in the retention space **146** in the manner described above with respect to the distal bone sliver **107**. At least one ligament such as the plantar tarsometatarsal ligament **110** can be severed adjacent the proximal bone sliver **117** in the manner described above as desired. It should be appreciated that the distal bone sliver **107** can be removed prior to removing the proximal bone sliver **117**, or the proximal bone sliver **117** can be removed prior to removing the distal bone sliver **107**. The remaining portion **115b** of the cuneiform **108** can thus face or partially

define the resected joint **106**. The remaining portions **105b** and **115b** cooperate to define the resected joint **106**.

(62) Referring now to FIG. **10**, once the bone slivers **107** and **117** have been removed, sufficient space exists in the resected joint **106** to allow for the metatarsal **104** to be positionally adjusted to correct the deformity. The correction system can further include a correction guide **300** that can be inserted over the K-wires **111-114** to drive the metatarsal **104** to move from a deformed position to a corrected position that adjusts an angle between the metatarsal **104** and the cuneiform **108**, correcting the bunion **102**. The correction guide **300** includes a correction body **307**, and a plurality of guide apertures **302** that extend through the correction body **307**. The guide apertures **302** can be sized and shaped to receive respective ones of the K-wires **111-114** so as to positionally adjust the metatarsal **104** with respect to the cuneiform.

(63) In particular, the guide apertures **302** can include at least one first or distal guide aperture such as first and second guide apertures **303** and **304** that extend through the guide body **307**. The first and second guide apertures **303** and **304** can be oriented parallel to each other. The first and second guide apertures **303** and **304** can be referred to as distal guide apertures. The guide aperture **303** can be positioned distal of the guide aperture **304**. The first guide aperture **303** can thus be referred to as an outer distal guide aperture, and the second guide aperture **304** can be referred to as an inner distal guide aperture. The first guide aperture **303** is configured to receive the first K-wire **111**, and the second guide aperture **304** is configured to receive the second K-wire **112**.

(64) The guide apertures **302** can further include at least one second or proximal guide aperture, such as third and fourth guide apertures **305** and **306** that extend through the guide body **307**. The first and second guide apertures **303** and **304** can be oriented parallel to each other. The third and fourth guide apertures **305** and **306** can be referred to as proximal guide apertures. The third guide aperture **305** can be positioned proximal of the fourth guide aperture **306**. The third guide aperture **305** can thus be referred to as an outer proximal guide aperture, and the fourth guide aperture **306** can be referred to as an inner proximal guide aperture. The third guide aperture **305** is configured to receive the third K-wire **113**, and the fourth guide aperture **306** is configured to receive the fourth K-wire **114**.

(65) The guide apertures **302** can be sized substantially equal to the received ones of the K-wires **111-114**. Further, the proximal apertures and the distal apertures can have a spatial relationship with respect to each other that is different than the spatial relationship between the proximal k-wires and the distal k-wires. For instance, in one example, the guide apertures **302** can all be aligned with each other along the guide body **307**. In other examples, the first and second guide apertures **303-304** can be spaced from each other along a first aperture spacing direction, and the third and fourth guide apertures **305-306** are spaced from each other along a second aperture spacing direction that is angularly offset with respect to the first aperture spacing direction. Further, the guide apertures **302** can all be oriented parallel with each other. It will thus be appreciated that the guide apertures **302** can be arranged along the guide body **307** such the distal K-wires are repositioned to fit in the distal guide apertures when the proximal K-wires are disposed in the proximal guide apertures. Repositioning the distal K-wires correspondingly repositions that metatarsal **104** with respect to the cuneiform **108**. In one example, the metatarsal **104** angulates in the frontal plane with respect to the cuneiform **108**. The alignment guide **300** is further described in U.S. Pat. No. 11,058,546, the entirety of which is hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes. In another example, the apertures **302** can cause a realignment of the metatarsal **104** and the cuneiform **108** and/or compression between the metatarsal **104** and the cuneiform **108** into the corrected configuration. An example correction guide is the compressor block described in U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2021/0251670, the entirety of which is hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes.

(66) The correction guide **300** can also include one or more cross-pin holes **301** that is configured to receive a respective one or more fixing member such as fixing K-wires **411** that temporarily or permanently secures the joint **106** in the corrected configuration. The correction system can thus

further include the one or more fixing K-wires **411**. The fixing K-wire **411** can be driven through the cross-pin hole **301**, through the metatarsal **104**, and into the cuneiform **108**. Thus, the cross-pin hole **301** maintains the metatarsal **104** in the corrected realigned position. The correction guide **300** can then be removed by removing the k-wires **111-112** and **113-114** from the metatarsal **104** and cuneiform **108**, respectively, and further from the correction guide **300**. Next, the correction guide **300** can be removed from the fixing k-wire **411** by sliding the correction guide **300** along the fixing K-wire **411** away from the patient's foot **100** until the correction guide **300** has been removed from the fixing K-wire **411**.

(67) As shown in FIG. **11**, the correction system can further include a bone fixation implant or plate **400** that is configured to be fixed to the repositioned metatarsal **104** and the cuneiform **108** across the resected joint, thereby fixing the metatarsal **104** in the realigned position. The fixing plate **400** can include a plate body **403** and a plurality of fixation apertures **404** that extend through the plate body **403**. In particular, the fixation apertures **404** can include at least one first or proximal fixation aperture **401** such as a pair of proximal fixation apertures **401** that extend through the plate body **403**. The fixation apertures **404** can further include at least one second or distal fixation aperture **402** that extends through the plate body **403**. The bone plate **400** can be positioned on the patient's foot **100** such that the at least one proximal fixation aperture **401** is aligned with the cuneiform **108**, and the at least one distal fixation aperture **402** is aligned with the repositioned metatarsal **104**.

(68) The fixation apertures are configured to receive bone fixation members such as bone screws **502**. In particular, at least one bone screw **502** can be driven through a respective at least one of the at least one proximal fixation aperture **401** and into the cuneiform **108**, and at least one bone screw **502** can be driven through a respective at least one of the at least one distal fixation aperture **402** and into the metatarsal **104**. Thus, the fixation plate **400** permanently positionally stabilizes the metatarsal **104** with respect to the cuneiform **108**, thereby allowing the resected joint **106** to fuse.

(69) The fixation plate **400** can include any number of fixation apertures **404** as desired.

Alternatively or additionally, the fixation plate **400** can be configured to receive a compression staple **510**. In particular, the fixation plate **400** can include first and second staple apertures **407** and **408**, respectively, that extend through the plate body **403**. The first staple aperture **407** can be a proximal staple aperture that extends through the plate body **403** in alignment with the cuneiform **108**. The second staple aperture **408** can be a distal staple aperture that extends through the plate body **403** in alignment with the metatarsal **104**. The first and second staple apertures **407** and **408** can receive first and second legs, respectively, of the compression staple **510**. The compression staple **510** can include a bridge **512** that extends from the first leg to the second leg. Thus, the bridge **512** can span the resected joint **106**. The legs of the staple can be biased toward each other so as to provide compression across the resected joint **106**. The fixation plate **400** is described in U.S. Pat. No. 11,058,546 and U.S. Pat. Pub. No. 2021/0251670, which are hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes. Once the bone fixation plate **400** has been fixed to the metatarsal **104** and the cuneiform **108**, the fixing K-wire **411** can be removed from the patient's foot **100**.

(70) Certain Terminology

(71) Terms of orientation used herein, such as “top,” “bottom,” “proximal,” “distal,” “longitudinal,” “lateral,” and “end,” are used in the context of the illustrated example. However, the present disclosure should not be limited to the illustrated orientation. Indeed, other orientations are possible and are within the scope of this disclosure. Terms relating to circular shapes as used herein, such as diameter or radius, should be understood not to require perfect circular structures, but rather should be applied to any suitable structure with a cross-sectional region that can be measured from side-to-side. Terms relating to shapes generally, such as “circular,” “cylindrical,” “semi-circular,” or “semi-cylindrical” or any related or similar terms, are not required to conform strictly to the mathematical definitions of circles or cylinders or other structures, but can encompass structures that are reasonably close approximations.

(72) Conditional language, such as “can,” “could,” “might,” or “may,” unless specifically stated



otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain examples include or do not include, certain features, elements, and/or steps. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements, and/or steps are in any way required for one or more examples.

(73) Conjunctive language, such as the phrase “at least one of X, Y, and Z,” unless specifically stated otherwise, is otherwise understood with the context as used in general to convey that an item, term, etc. may be either X, Y, or Z. Thus, such conjunctive language is not generally intended to imply that certain examples require the presence of at least one of X, at least one of Y, and at least one of Z.

(74) As used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” can include the plural unless indicated otherwise. The term “plurality”, as used herein, means more than one, and reference to a plurality herein can be used with equal force and effect to the singular. When a range of values is expressed, another embodiment includes from the one particular value and/or to the other particular value. Similarly, when values are expressed as approximations, by use of the antecedent “about,” it will be understood that the particular value forms another embodiment. All ranges are inclusive and combinable.

(75) The terms “approximately,” “about,” and “substantially” as used herein represent an amount close to the stated amount that still performs a desired function or achieves a desired result. For example, in some examples, as the context may dictate, the terms “approximately,” “about,” and “substantially,” may refer to an amount that is within less than or equal to 10% of the stated amount. The term “generally” as used herein represents a value, amount, or characteristic that predominantly includes or tends toward a particular value, amount, or characteristic. As an example, in certain examples, as the context may dictate, the term “generally parallel” can refer to something that departs from exactly parallel by less than or equal to 20 degrees. All ranges are inclusive of endpoints.

## SUMMARY

(76) Several illustrative examples of surgical instruments have been disclosed. Although this disclosure has been described in terms of certain illustrative examples and uses, other examples and other uses, including examples and uses which do not provide all of the features and advantages set forth herein, are also within the scope of this disclosure. Components, elements, features, acts, or steps can be arranged or performed differently than described and components, elements, features, acts, or steps can be combined, merged, added, or left out in various examples. All possible combinations and subcombinations of elements and components described herein are intended to be included in this disclosure. No single feature or group of features is necessary or indispensable.

(77) Certain features that are described in this disclosure in the context of separate implementations can also be implemented in combination in a single implementation. Conversely, various features that are described in the context of a single implementation also can be implemented in multiple implementations separately or in any suitable subcombination. Moreover, although features may be described above as acting in certain combinations, one or more features from a claimed combination can in some cases be excised from the combination, and the combination may be claimed as a subcombination or variation of a subcombination.

(78) Any portion of any of the steps, processes, structures, and/or devices disclosed or illustrated in one example in this disclosure can be combined or used with (or instead of) any other portion of any of the steps, processes, structures, and/or devices disclosed or illustrated in a different example or flowchart. The examples described herein are not intended to be discrete and separate from each other. Combinations, variations, and some implementations of the disclosed features are within the scope of this disclosure.

(79) While operations may be depicted in the drawings or described in the specification in a particular order, such operations need not be performed in the particular order shown or in sequential order, or that all operations be performed, to achieve desirable results. Other operations

that are not depicted or described can be incorporated in the example methods and processes. For example, one or more additional operations can be performed before, after, simultaneously, or between any of the described operations. Additionally, the operations may be rearranged or reordered in some implementations. Also, the separation of various components in the implementations described above should not be understood as requiring such separation in all implementations, and it should be understood that the described components and systems can generally be integrated together in a single product or packaged into multiple products.

Additionally, some implementations are within the scope of this disclosure.

(80) Further, while illustrative examples have been described, any examples having equivalent elements, modifications, omissions, and/or combinations are also within the scope of this disclosure. Moreover, although certain aspects, advantages, and novel features are described herein, not necessarily all such advantages may be achieved in accordance with any particular example. For example, some examples within the scope of this disclosure achieve one advantage, or a group of advantages, as taught herein without necessarily achieving other advantages taught or suggested herein. Further, some examples may achieve different advantages than those taught or suggested herein.

(81) Some examples have been described in connection with the accompanying drawings. The figures are drawn and/or shown to scale, but such scale should not be limiting, since dimensions and proportions other than what are shown are contemplated and are within the scope of the disclosed invention. Distances, angles, etc. are merely illustrative and do not necessarily bear an exact relationship to actual dimensions and layout of the devices illustrated. Components can be added, removed, and/or rearranged. Further, the disclosure herein of any particular feature, aspect, method, property, characteristic, quality, attribute, element, or the like in connection with various examples can be used in all other examples set forth herein. Additionally, any methods described herein may be practiced using any device suitable for performing the recited steps.

(82) For purposes of summarizing the disclosure, certain aspects, advantages and features of the inventions have been described herein. Not all, or any such advantages are necessarily achieved in accordance with any particular example of the inventions disclosed herein. No aspects of this disclosure are essential or indispensable. In many examples, the devices, systems, and methods may be configured differently than illustrated in the figures or description herein. For example, various functionalities provided by the illustrated modules can be combined, rearranged, added, or deleted. In some implementations, additional or different processors or modules may perform some or all of the functionalities described with reference to the examples described and illustrated in the figures. Many implementation variations are possible. Any of the features, structures, steps, or processes disclosed in this specification can be included in any example.

(83) In summary, various examples of surgical instruments and related methods have been disclosed. This disclosure extends beyond the specifically disclosed examples to other alternative examples and/or other uses of the examples, as well as to certain modifications and equivalents thereof. Moreover, this disclosure expressly contemplates that various features and aspects of the disclosed examples can be combined with, or substituted for, one another. Accordingly, the scope of this disclosure should not be limited by the particular disclosed examples described above, but should be determined only by a fair reading of the claims.

## Claims

1. A method of correcting alignment between a first and second bones across a joint, the method comprising the steps of: cutting the first bone so as to define a first end portion and a remaining bone portion of the first bone separated from each other by a resection cut, wherein the first end portion faces the joint; driving a paddle member of a removal tool along a direction of insertion into the joint between the first end portion and the second bone, such that a paddle head of the

paddle member faces the first end portion; driving an insertion member of the removal tool along the direction of insertion into the resection cut, such that the first end portion is captured between the insertion member and the paddle head; and removing the first end portion from the joint while the first end portion is captured between the insertion member and the paddle head.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the step of driving the insertion member causes retention features of the paddle member to bear against the first end portion.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the retention features extend in a direction opposite the insertion direction as they project out from a surface of the paddle member.
4. The method of claim 3, wherein the insertion member comprises an extension that is spaced from the paddle head along a second direction that is less than a thickness of the first end portion, and the insertion member defines a blade having a bevel that extends to a tip, such that the tip is spaced from the paddle a distance that is greater than the thickness of the first end portion, wherein the second direction is perpendicular to the insertion direction.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein one of the insertion member and the paddle member is flexible so as to provide a normal retention force against the first end portion.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the step of driving the insertion member comprises causing a cutting tip of the insertion member travel past the paddle head.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein the step of driving the insertion member causes the cutting tip to sever a soft tissue attachment that is connected to the first end portion and the second bone.
8. The method of claim 6, wherein the soft tissue comprises a plantar tarsometatarsal ligament, and the joint is a TMT joint.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein the step of driving the insertion member comprises causing a cutting tip of the insertion member to completely separate the first end portion from the remaining portion of the first bone, such that the first end portion defines a first bone sliver.
10. The method of claim 1, wherein the first end portion is completely separated from the remaining portion of the first bone, such that the first end portion defines a first bone sliver.
11. The method of claim 1, wherein the step of driving the insertion member comprises driving an extension of the insertion member through a channel of a housing that also receives the paddle member.
12. The method of claim 11, wherein the step of driving the insertion member comprises engaging a handle with a thumb, grasping the housing member with one or more fingers, and driving the handle in the insertion direction so as to drive the extension in the insertion direction, wherein the extension extends from the handle.
13. The method of claim 1, further comprising the steps of driving at least one K-wire into the first bone, driving at least one K-wire into the second bone, and inserting a correction guide over the K-wires after cutting the first and second bones, thereby repositioning the first bone with respect to the second bone.
14. The method of claim 13, wherein the first bone is a metatarsal bone, the second bone is a cuneiform, and the joint is a TMT joint.
15. A bone removal tool comprising: a housing including an upper end, a lower end opposite the upper end in a downward direction, and a channel extending from the upper end to the lower end; a paddle member extending from the lower end of the housing, the paddle member including a paddle shaft and a paddle head; and an insertion member translatably received within the channel, such that the insertion member is translatable in the downward direction with respect to the paddle member from a retracted position to an advanced position.
16. The bone removal tool of claim 15, wherein the paddle head defines a surface that faces the insertion member when the insertion member is in the advanced position, and the head comprises a plurality of retention features that extend from the surface toward the insertion member.
17. The bone removal tool of claim 16, wherein the retention features extend in an upward direction opposite the downward direction as they extend away from the surface of the paddle head.

18. The bone removal tool of claim 15, wherein the insertion member comprises a handle and an extension that extends from the handle, wherein the insertion member is translatable in the downward direction until the handle is received by a concave surface of the housing.
  19. The bone removal tool of claim 15, wherein the extension is oriented substantially parallel with the paddle shaft.
  20. The bone removal tool of claim 15, wherein the insertion member includes a cutting tip that is offset from the paddle head in the downward direction when the insertion member is in the advanced position.
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